WHAT WOULD THE SECOND CUSTOMER SEE?

I asked one question before letting anybody else onto my platform, and it stopped the pilot.

ONE QUESTION, ASKED LATE

I had a working platform, eleven people in it every day, and three shops interested in a pilot. So I went looking for the thing that would embarrass me.

Not a bug. A shape. If a second company signed in tomorrow, what could they see that was not theirs?

THE THING THAT BLOCKED THE SALE

1

column. That was the whole blocker. Not a module, not a redesign, one column that assumed there would only ever be one company in here.

Software written for one shop grows a quiet assumption in every table. Mine had grown it 104 models deep.

FIVE THINGS THAT HAVE TO BE TRUE

01	Every row knows which company it belongs to	DATA
02	Every query is filtered by that before it reaches a page	READ
03	Every file sits in a private bucket served to one session	STORAGE
04	Every integration writes back to the tenant that owns it	INBOUND
05	Every one of those has a test that fails loudly when it breaks	PROOF

The fifth one is the one people skip, and it is the only one that keeps holding after you forget.

TWO WAYS TO FIND THIS OUT

THE EXPENSIVE WAY

Pilot first

Sign a design partner, load their book, and discover the assumption when somebody sees a name they should not have seen.

THE CHEAP WAY

Ask first

Spend three weeks on isolation and permissions before anybody else has an account. Nobody is watching, so nothing is at stake.

Same work either way. Wildly different day.

> **Before you sell software to a second customer, go and find the place where you assumed there would only ever be one.**
>
> IT IS ALWAYS THERE. SOFTWARE THAT GREW INSIDE ONE COMPANY ALWAYS HAS IT.

This applies to a spreadsheet you share as much as a platform you host.

WHAT THE PHASE WILL NOT DO

Phase one is isolation, a repeatable install, a partner scorecard and a proof receipt. No new modules.

It does not advance until three to five shops are running it on their own Slack and beating their own baseline. If that does not happen, more features would not have saved it anyway.

PILOTS OPEN WHEN ISOLATION CLOSES

If you run a promo shop and want to be one of the first three, the door is a request rather than a signup.

THREE TO FIVE PARTNERS | YOUR OWN SLACK | NO SEAT COUNT YET

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